

114 Dawn of War 2

Command an arsenal of vehicles, weapons and even a killer grappling hook, leaving a country in smoking ruins at the end



Croc: Legend of the Gobbos

Croc is a third person 3D game with some very well designed gaming environments. The game is a 3D platformer, and the protagonist is a crocodile in a strange land. Over the course of the game, players have to collect crystals, navigate across many islands. Each island has a graphic theme, the ice domain being our favorite. The game has some nice touches, Croc will slip frequently in the ice levels, and there are some elaborate puzzles to solve on the way as well. This is a long and engaging game, and when you are done, there is a sequel, Croc II, which is as good.

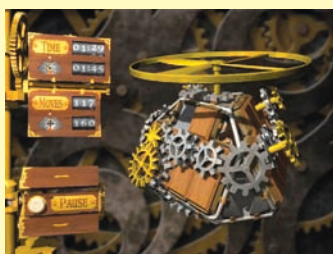
116 Unwind

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Feature

Metal Fatigue

Metal Fatigue is a RTS that was released in 2000. The game still plays pretty well, provided players are not expecting a typical RTS game. Metal Fatigue stands out in the sense that there are only a handful of units, most of the game-play involves creating and deploying Combots (combat robots), or giant fighting mechas, and who does not like these. The Combots have to be "grown" in parts, and assembled, before being unleashed on enemy forces. Players can also re-use abandoned parts of Combots. There are three campaigns, RimTech, MilAgro and Neuropa, focusing on the various aspects of the gameplay (speed, strength, stealth etc). This game does not play well on Windows 7.



Cogs

Cogs is an indie puzzle game, and is a pretty inventive one when it comes to designing new challenges. Each level in the game can be considered a separate puzzle to solve. Players have to complete a number of contraptions by moving around blocks, these range from flying cubes, gas filled flying balloons, to steam engines. The replayability of this game is very high, as there are a number of awards for completing a level in a minimum number of moves, as well as a minimum amount of time. Apart from the inventor mode, the challenge mode can also be unlocked, which is a set of time trials or lowest-move games. Although the levels don't become increasingly tough, you do need to think out of the box every now and then to solve some puzzles.



Severance: Blade of Darkness

This is a RPG game from the turn of the century, and has amazing graphics considering the time it came out. Players can choose from four different characters, The Barbarian called Tukaram (yes, we would like to know why they chose this name too), Naglfar the not-so-short dwarf, Sargon the Knight or Zoe the thief/huntress. The game has stunning environments, with some great work on aspects such as light rays in lamps, or the refraction on water surfaces. The over-the-top combat is the heart of the game, and the most gripping aspect. There are a number of weapons to choose from, and some very satisfying combos to discover. The animations on the weapons are something to look forward to in this game.

Star Guard

Star Guard is the only Flash game on the list. It is a stand-alone executable, and use very minimal graphics to present a very accomplished game. You have to guide a small green man down into the catacombs, crossing hordes of monsters and obstacles. The platformer is very basic in terms of looks, but pretty innovative in terms of gameplay. Fortunately, you can save the progress, and this is not an easy game to play. The game is good at throwing new things to catch you off-guard, and it is refreshingly entertaining to play with some old school graphics. The game would not look out of place in the Alley Cat days.



Jazz Jackrabbit

Jazz Jackrabbit is an old sidescrolling adventure game, and is fun despite the outrageously dated graphics. This is a

game from the DOS era, so playing it on modern machines requires a DOS emulator such as DOSBox. You play as a fire shooting, hoverboarding rabbit in search of princess Earlong. The levels are typical platformer fare, but the soundtrack is pretty catchy, and has some early forms of ninjatune elements. The game is a sort of a revenge on the tortoise-and-hare story, as the enemy is played by a monstrous (and evil) tortoise.